Benefits of Antioxidants

- Slower signs of aging, including of the skin, eyes, tissue, joints, heart and brain
- Healthier, more youthful, glowing skin
- Reduced cancer risk
- Detoxification support
- Longer life span
- Protection against heart disease and stroke
- Less risk for cognitive problems, such as dementia
- Reduced risk for vision loss or disorders like macular degeneration and cataracts
- Antioxidants are also added to food or household products to prevent oxidation and spoilage

7.4 Nutrigenetics

The study of **Nutrigenetics** concentrates on how even slight variations in our genetic code, affect our nutrient needs, susceptibility to particular diseases and response to our environment.

7.5 Nutrigenomics

Nutrigenomics is a branch of nutritional genomics and it is the study of the effects of foods and food constituents on gene expression.

7.6 Functional components of Fruits and vegetables

7.6.1 Red Fruits and Vegetables

The phytochemicals present in red coloured fruits and vegetables are **carotenoids and anthocyanins.** One of the most abundant carotenoids present in fruits is Lycopene, which helps reduce damage from free radicals in our body and it prevents heart diseases, cancer, prostrate problems and reduces the skin damage from the sun. Red fruits and vegetables are also often very high in vitamin C, which helps in cellular renewal in the body.

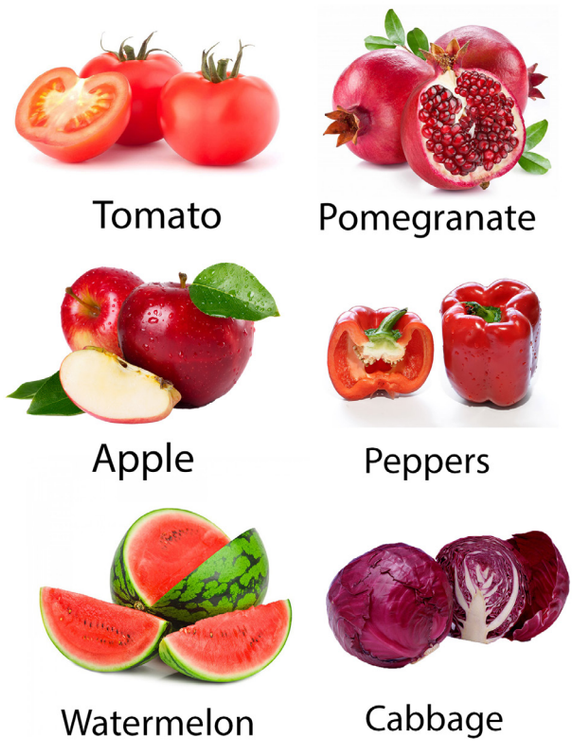


Fig 7.1: Red Fruits and Vegetables

7.6.2 Orange Fruits and Vegetables

Carotenoids are the powerful phytochemicals in orange coloured fruits and vegetables, and they give the fruits the bright color. Carotenoids repair DNA and help prevent cancer and heart disease, as well as strengthening our vision.

These orange foods also give the requited amount of potassium , vitamin A, B complex vitamin which keeps eyes and skin healthy and protects against infections.

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